

MICHAEL KLEINBRIEL

Unity Developer | Technical Designer | Technical Artist

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PROJECTS

VR DISTRACTED DRIVING AWARENESS – VR SIM JAN 2026 - PRESENT

Virtual Reality Designer, Level Designer, Technical Artist, Optimization

- Designed, built, and iterated the complete VR driving environment in Unity for Meta Quest 3
- Optimized rendering using Unity's Profiler, Frame Debugger, and rendering pipeline features to improve performance while maintaining visual quality
- Developed interactive gameplay systems in Unity using C# within a collaborative production environment

REVOLUNAR – FPS ROGUELIKE JAN 2026 - MAY 2026

Co-Producer, Level Designer, Technical Artist

- Worked closely with industry partners at Iron Galaxy Studios and led meetings
- Integrated custom Unity rendering packages and visual effects tools to enhance the game's visual fidelity and artistic style
- Created level blockouts and gameplay spaces with a focus on player navigation and replayability
- Designed and implemented custom shaders in Unity Shader Graph to improve readability, visual communication, and performance

THOOBER – ONLINE FPS ARENA MOVEMENT SHOOTER SEPT 2025 - PRESENT

Gameplay Programmer, Technical Designer, Systems Programmer

- Developed initial player movement systems in Unity using C#, including robust stair and slope traversal
- Built an automated scene management system to dynamically populate game menus
- Implemented modular backend systems for round modifiers and gameplay customization
- Added full controller support and input handling across gameplay systems

SPELL FORGE – PVPVE SPELLCRAFTING ROGUELIKE JUNE 2025 - DEC 2025

Producer, Technical Designer, UI Designer, VFX Artist

- Assembled a team with complementary skill sets to maximize development efficiency and meet project goals
- Designed gameplay systems, combat mechanics, and one of the project's two playable environments
- Designed and implemented all custom shaders and all but two visual effects for gameplay and environmental assets
- Developed a custom rendering system that ensured shaders and visual effects maintained a consistent pixel-art aesthetic

WORK EXPERIENCE

MSU COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING JAN 2026 - PRESENT

Virtual Reality Designer, Technical Designer, Technical Artist

- Collaborated with stakeholders and non-gaming users to refine usability and improve accessibility
- Quickly integrated into an established Unity project already four months into production, adapting to existing workflows and C# codebase
- Contributed beyond primary responsibilities by supporting technical design, technical art, and environment development to address evolving team needs

MSU SPARTASOFT STUDIO – TEAM SIZE: 30-80 DEVS AUG 2022 - MAY 2026

Club President, Design Director, Level Designer, Player Designer, Narrative Designer, QA

- Club President** – Restructured studio into a new sustainable and accessible format
- Design Director** – Co-led teams of talented designers, ensured production milestones were met, mentored designers, team recognized for exceeding expectations and goals
- Level, Player, Narrative Designer** – Iterated on level blockouts with level team, created tools to help other designers, fleshed out narrative with Art team
- QA** – Helped research, design, and present QoL features for a project
- General Member** – Developed Thoober with small team, helped present project to industry professionals at Gearbox Software, helped found LLC to publish game

MSU COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING AUG 2023 - JULY 2025

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant for CSE 102 – Algorithmic Thinking and Programming

- Co-led 6 classes of ~30 students and supported 1000+ students via Piazza
- Taught non-CS majors programming fundamentals with Python
- Honed skills to help students without directly giving them answers, which allowed them to achieve success on their own and feel proud and retain that knowledge
- Recognized by students as a helpful resource, personally asked to write letters of recs for college

SKILLS

Programming

C#
Python
HTML/CSS

Game Engines

Unity
Unreal Engine

Graphics & Technical Art

Unity Shader Graph
Unreal Material Editor
Blender
Houdini
Substance Painter
Substance Designer

Tools

Visual Studio / VS Code
Jet Brains Rider
Git
Jira
Trello
Microsoft Office

EDUCATION

MICHIGAN STATE UNIVERSITY, 2026 WITH HONORS

B.A. Games & Interactive Media (Honors College)

Minor: Game Design and Development

GPA: 3.964/4